

Outlook

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The USD settlement pattern needs a closer look

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Correspondent payment delays and beneficiary-routing alerts may be creating both liquidity noise and financial-crime exposure. The discussion is currently being driven by anecdotes, and the teams involved are describing the same customers differently.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if late confirmations explain most breaks?
2. What evidence would instead support that split payments are concentrating on common beneficiaries?
3. How do we rule out that specific intermediaries create repeated settlement delay?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use March 2025 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards whether to change correspondent limits, escalate a bank relationship or tighten pre-payment review. A useful output would be a one-page finding note plus the underlying CSV for our own review.

Use SWIFT messages, correspondent alerts and nostro breaks; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly customer and KYC snapshots; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories. One caution: Do not infer the bank's full nostro position from exception records.

Regards